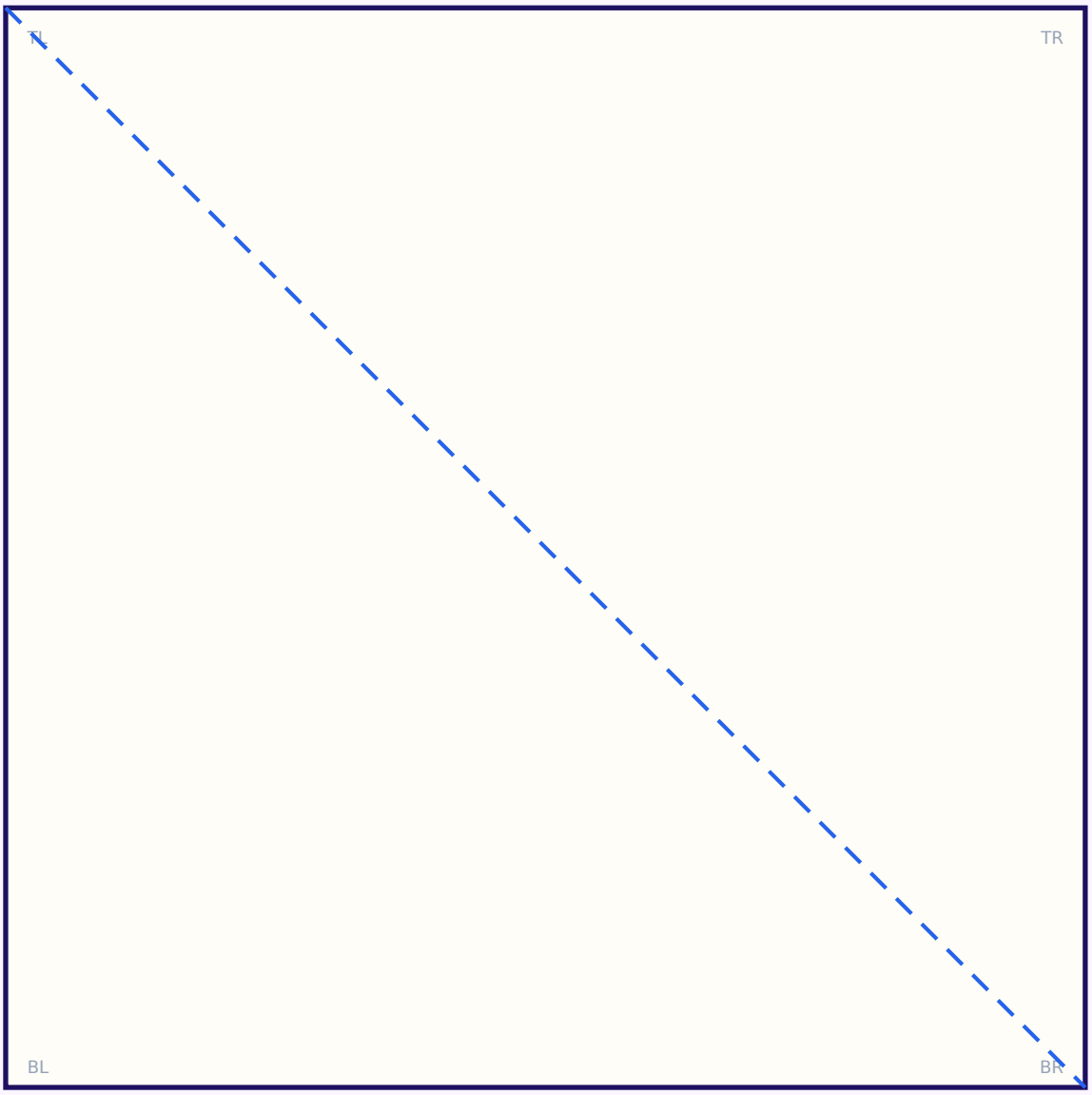
PRINT AT 100% / ACTUAL SIZE — Do NOT “fit to page”

Fold a Paper Cup

Ages 6+ · ~10 minutes · Square 150 × 150 mm · Coding idea: steps = an algorithm

True-size square 150 × 150 mm (cut from A4 if needed)



Cut on the solid outer edge if your paper is not already square. Blue dashed = first valley crease (fold toward you).

150 mm

Symbol key

Valley (fold toward you)

Mountain (fold away)

↻ Turn over → Fold arrow ✓ Check silhouette ★ Finished cup

You need

- 1 square paper 150 mm
- Clean hands · Flat table
- Optional: cup of water to test!

Coding / maths link

An algorithm is a list of steps in order. Skip a fold and the cup fails — just like a bug!



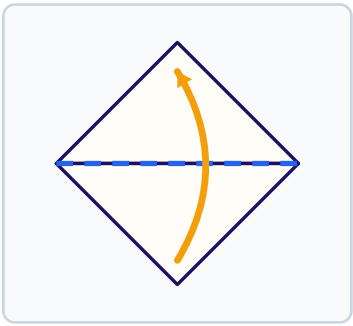
Measure: this bar must be exactly 100 mm. Print at 100%, not "fit to page".



Origami for Kids · Project #01 · Paper Cup · Steps 1–7 · page 2/2 (1:1 scale)

PRINT AT 100% / ACTUAL SIZE

1 Big triangle

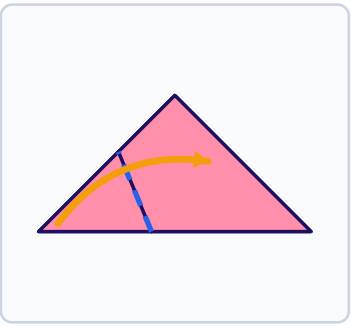


DO
Coloured side down, like a diamond. Fold the bottom corner up.

CHECK ✓
A big triangle, fold at the bottom.

TIP
Crease with a fingernail.

2 Left corner across

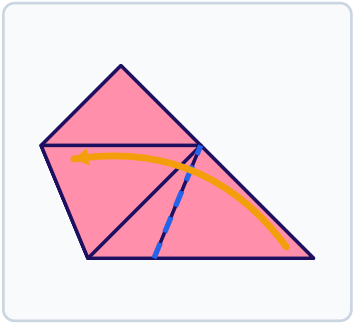


DO
Fold the left corner across until it touches the right edge.

CHECK ✓
The top of the flap is level.

TIP
Keep the flap flat.

3 Right corner across

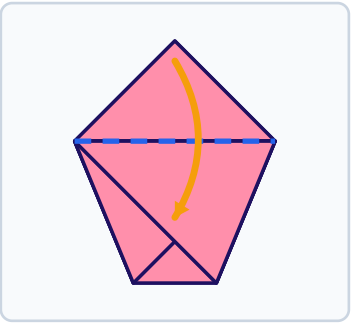


DO
Fold the right corner across to the left edge.

CHECK ✓
Both sides match (symmetry).

TIP
Mirror the left fold.

4 Front flap down

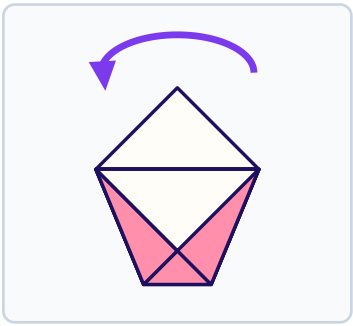


DO
Fold only the front top flap down over the front.

CHECK ✓
One flap down, one still up.

TIP
Only the front flap!

5 Turn over

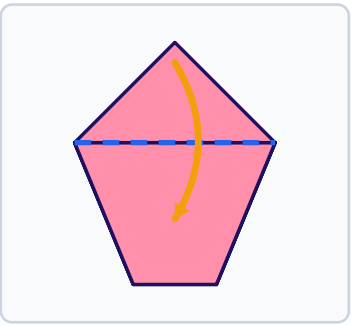


DO
Turn the whole thing over.

CHECK ✓
The other flap is on top.

TIP
Like flipping a pancake.

6 Back flap down

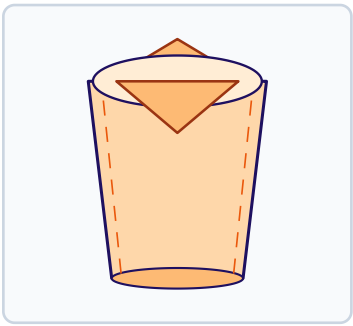


DO
Fold the last flap down the same way.

CHECK ✓
Both flaps are down.

TIP
Same move as step 4.

7 Open the cup

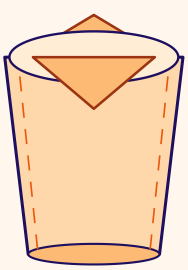


DO
Stand it up, then gently squeeze the sides so it pops open.

CHECK ✓
A hollow cup!

TIP
Gentle, do not tear it.

Finished!



Seven steps in order make a cup. That is an algorithm! Skip one and it will not work (a bug).

100 mm

Measure: this bar must be exactly 100 mm. Print at 100%, not "fit to page".

20 mm

Valley = dashed blue · Mountain = dash-dot red · @Kids.JoinDev